CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

# Core Item Update: Ethnic footwear 2026–28

Indian footwear is having a moment.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



# Overview

Indian footwear is having a moment. GI-tagged Kolhapuris rise after Prada's Spring/Summer 2026 show, block-heel juttis bring comfort to long events, and embellished wedding juttis and mojaris remain steady sellers.

| 3 | 0 | 3 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| INVEST | TEST | MAINTAIN | REDUCE |

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

# The details

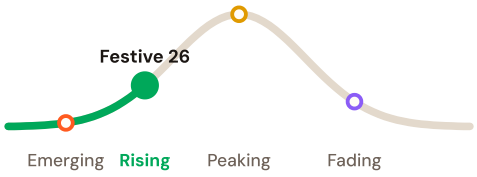
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

## Kolhapuri chappals

GI-tagged Kolhapuris, back in focus after Prada's Spring/Summer 2026 show. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 | Festive 28 | |



INVEST RISING

## Block-heel juttis

Juttis on a low block heel for comfort at long events. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Rising | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



INVEST RISING

## Mirror-work flats

Mirror embellishment moving onto shoes. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Fading |
| Summer 28 Fading | Festive 28 – | |



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Embellished wedding juttis

Juttis with zari, beads and mirror work for weddings. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |

Peaking

Fading



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Pointed juttis with bandhgalas

Pointed juttis as the correct shoe for bandhgalas. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 – | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 | Festive 28 | |



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Mojaris with kurta sets

Classic mojaris for festive kurta looks. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Peaking | |

| – | Peaking |
|---|---|

## How to update your ethnic footwear range

- Source authentic GI-tagged Kolhapuris and credit the Kolhapur cluster.
- Add block-heel juttis for comfort at long functions.
- Keep embellished wedding juttis and mojaris as core festive pairings.
- Reduce mirror-work flats after Summer 27.

## What to check in ethnic footwear development

- **Comfort:** cushioned insoles and soft linings matter for long events.
- **Sizing:** traditional styles often run differently; give foot-length guidance.
- **Soles:** leather soles look traditional, rubber soles add grip.
- **Embellishment:** secure beads and threads on high-wear areas.

## Fabric guide

Choose fabric by occasion, climate and price point. The same design often needs two fabric options: a premium version and a value or summer version.

- Leather juttis and Kolhapuris
- Velvet and silk uppers for festive
- Embroidered and mirror-work details
- Vegan leather alternatives for some customers

## The global view

Indian ethnic footwear sell well beyond India, to South Asian communities in the UK, North America, the Gulf, Southeast Asia and Australia, and increasingly to customers discovering Indian craft. For international customers, provide clear size conversions, care guidance and styling ideas for local events.

## Common questions

**Are juttis comfortable?** Modern versions with padded insoles and softer leathers are much more comfortable than traditional ones.

**What is GI-tagged footwear?** Kolhapuri chappals from parts of Maharashtra and Karnataka have Geographical Indication protection, linking the name to the region.

See every ethnic footwear detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).